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Critical Engagement with Literature

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- *Below you will find some models of criticality to help you engage critically with literature.*
- Criticality modelling Rata (2017)
- Criticality modelling Boaler and Broadie (2004)
- Criticality modelling Yang (2010)

Thinking critically about the literature

- Once you have critiqued a piece of literature write a summary of the position that has been taken by that author.
- Once you have summarised a few articles on a subject then compare the positions that have been presented.
- Which position aligns with your view the most?
- Which position opposes your view the most?
- Why?
- Summarise your own position.

How to use literature within your writing

It is better to avoid using direct quotes at post graduate level. Instead, summarise or paraphrase what the author has said.

For instance:

‘Teacher questioning has been identified as a critical and challenging part of teachers’ work.’ (Boaler and Brodie 2004 p.1)

Becomes:

Questioning is pivotal to teaching practice (Boaler and Broadie 2004).

How to use literature within your writing

- ▶ The literature informs your position and the arguments that you make. It is vital that you support your arguments with a reference to appropriate literature.